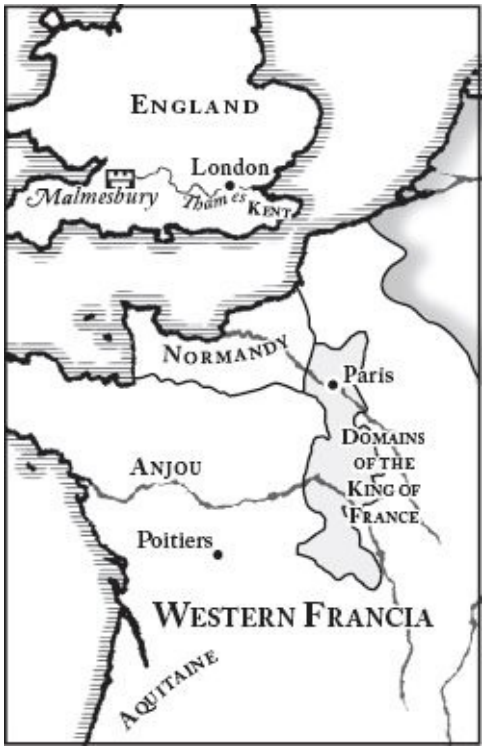
Humiliated, Henry went back to his studies. But in a short time, he was catapulted out of the schoolroom and back into war. Four years after the embarrassment in England, his father Geoffrey Plantagenet died of a fever, and the eighteen-year-old Henry became both Count of Anjou and Duke of Normandy.

Within the year, he had doubled his territories.

Henry's overlord, the Capetian king Louis VII, was just recently returned from the Second Crusade. On the way back from Jerusalem, he had stopped off in Italy to consult with the pope over the advisability of annulling his marriage to Eleanor of Aquitaine. But the pope had not only refused to discuss annulment (he "forbade any future mention" of it, writes John of Salisbury, "on pain of anathema") but had shut the estranged couple into a bedroom furnished with a single bed ("which he had decked with priceless hangings of his own") to encourage them along.[3]



11.1 Anjou, Normandy, and England

This strategy backfired. Eleanor became pregnant, but her second child, like her first, was a girl. Until this point, Louis had resisted Eleanor's unhappiness; now, the queen's failure to produce a male heir meant that Louis resigned himself to ending the marriage. With the help of the ubiquitous Bernard of Clairvaux (who had never approved of Eleanor), he again applied to Rome for annulment. The pope yielded to the inevitable, and the marriage